[LIT-CHLD-002] Sikui Kala Machun

Translation: The Deer and the Crab

Work Type: CHILDREN_LITERATURE | Creator: TLS Primary Curriculum Committee | Year: 2022
Village: Ukhrul | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: BK-TLS-001
Publisher / Source: Tangkhul Literature Society, Manipur
Clearance: Educational Use | Permission: permitted | Status: verified

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Themes: The classic trickster fable: slow wits versus rapid agility,
Humility and the folly of boastful overconfidence, Resourceful problem-
Structure & Meter: Short humorous fable with dynamic narrative pacing and dialogue, follo

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Critical Overview: Curated in the Class II primary reader Wontui Tangkhul
(2022), this story teaches young children that wit and steadiness overcome

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Sikui (Deer) na Machun (Crab)-li racing-li challenge sakda, 'Nakhurli pa
Machunna clever-laka da Sikuiwui kachei-li khangarom-da finish line-li a
Kacham-kacham mibingna speed-wui matuida clever strategy kala patience-n

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

The swift Deer (*Sikui*) challenged the slow Crab (*Machun*) to a race,
Yet the astute crab clung discreetly to the deer's tail, tumbling forwar
Thus children learn that unbridled pride is outmatched by clever foresig

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Sikui : The wild barking deer of the mountain forests
* Machun : The river crab dwelling in rocky mountain streams
* Khangayei : Clever wit and inventive trickery